resources, to how to ensure that all Indians had access to food, education and jobs.

Fortunately, scientists, industrialists, educationists and others who were experts in their fields came forward to take up positions of responsibility. Many of them came from relatively privileged backgrounds and had benefitted from being educated at premier institutions both in India and abroad. Fuelled by the desire to contribute to the country's progress, they helped expand India's capacities in fields like technology, agriculture and education, and encouraged economic development.

Among these individuals were the people profiled in this section. They laid the foundations of many of the institutions and programmes Indians continue to benefit from today.

ABUL KALAM MOHIUDDIN AHMED

1888–1958